



Tropical rain forests cover around 6 percent of the world's land, yet produce 40 percent of all oxygen and are often called the lungs of the Earth. The Leuser Ecosystem covers around 10,100 sq miles (26,300 sq km), about the size of Massachusetts. However, rain forest cover in Indonesia is rapidly decreasing to make room for palm oil plantations,

hydroelectric dams, and farming. Increase in demand for lumber and wood pulp for paper has led to a rise in illegal logging. Human activity is putting many of the species of plants and animals in the region, which are not found anywhere else in the world, at risk of extinction. It also threatens the health of the whole planet.